Technical English 2

Technical English Exercises: Charlie Kirk Article

SESSION 1 – READING, SPEAKING, VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR |

Introduction to the Article

About the Article

The article covers Charlie Kirk, social media activism, the MAGA movement, and internet culture references connected to a shooting incident in the United States.

Educational Purpose

Develop technical English skills through real-world content: reading comprehension, vocabulary, grammar, and critical thinking in context.

Why This Text?

Real journalistic language exposes students to authentic vocabulary, discourse structures, and current socio-political topics in English.

Before Reading – Speaking Part 1

1a. Do you know Charlie Kirk? Explain who he is.

1b. What does "MAGA" mean?

1c. What type of text is this? Identify elements (news article, opinion, report).

Before Reading – Listening Activity

Watch the video about Charlie Kirk and answer the following questions. Discuss your answers with a partner before sharing with the class.

2a. Describe what Charlie Kirk used to do. What was his background?

2b. What do you think of him? Share your personal opinion.

2c. What is his message and what is his relationship with his attendees?

Instruction: Watch the video carefully. Take notes while listening and be ready to discuss your answers in pairs or small groups.



After Reading Activities

Comprehension, Vocabulary & Writing Exercises

True or False

Instructions: Read each statement. Mark T (True) or F (False) and correct the false ones.

Paragraph 1: Charlie Kirk was shot during his vacation. T / F

Paragraph 2: The bullet had a phrase connected to furry internet culture. T / F

Paragrap 2: The phrase “OwO what’s this?” Comes from gamer culture only. T / F

Paragraph 3: The phrase was only used to insult people, never embraced by furries themselves .T / F

Paragraph 3: Know your meme is a website about viral culture T / F

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Paragraph 2: the message inscribed in the bullet is:

a) a romantic message
b) A shocking internet joke
c) a song lyric
d) a famous speech

2. Paragraph 4: The phrase “O Bella Ciao” refers to:

a) a new videogame
b) an antifascist song
c) a message from Charlie Kirk
d) a joke about gun rights

3. Paragraph 4: the arrow symbols on one casing come from:

a) TikTok trends
b) twitter memes
c) a videogame
d) YouTube comments

Short Answer Questions

1. How old is the shooter? Where is he from?

2. Where did the shooting incident happen?

3. What organization was Charlie Kirk representing at the university?

4. What were some of Kirk’s main political topics?

5. How did Kirk become famous online? Mention at least two platforms

General vocabulary

Define, explain or provide a synonym of the words in **bold and underlined** in the context of the article.

Specific vocabulary

Define, explain or provide a synonym of the words in green.

Vocabulary strategies: cognates

What are cognates?

Cognates are words in English that look like the ones in Spanish and share the same meaning. Recognising them helps in understanding a text without needing a dictionary.

Look at the words in blue and explain how they're similar to Spanish.

After Reading – Writing Task

Task: Summarize Each Paragraph

Write one summary sentence for each paragraph of the article. Focus on the main idea only — avoid copying sentences directly from the text.

Tips for Concise Writing

Use your own words. Keep each sentence under 20 words. Identify the subject, action, and key detail of each paragraph before writing.

Things to avoid:
Personal opinion (I think)
Too many examples or small details
Direct quotations
Adding information not in the text

Example Structure

Introduce the topic:
The text discusses...
The article focuses on...
The text examines...

Mention key ideas:
It explains that...
The author points out that...
The text highlights...
According to the article...

Connect the ideas (connectors):
Furthermore, in addition, moreover, however, as a result, meanwhile

Finish with the overall message:
Overall, the text shows that...
In conclusion, the article highlihgts...

Text structure:

Introduction
Main Points
Conclusion

After Reading – Speaking Part 2

Discuss the following questions in pairs or groups:

a) How is internet culture connected to real-world violence?

b) Can memes be dangerous? Why or why not?

c) The influence of social media in politics for young people.

d) Do you follow any influencers? Why?

Grammar Focus

Personal Pronouns · Present Simple · Present Continuous

Grammar – Personal Pronouns Overview

Subject Pronouns	Object Pronouns	Possessive Pronouns
I, you, he, she, it, we, they	me, you, him, her, it, us, them	mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs
Used as the subject of a verb (the doer of the action).	Used as the object of a verb or preposition (the receiver of the action).	Used to show ownership without repeating the noun.

Personal Pronouns – Examples & Usage

Study the sample sentences below. Each sentence shows a personal pronoun used as a subject, object, or in possessive form. Pay attention to how the pronoun changes depending on its role in the sentence.

Subject: She writes articles about politics. / They follow Kirk on social media.

Object: The reporter interviewed him. / The crowd cheered for them.

Possessive: The account is hers. / Their message spread quickly online.

Quick Exercise – Choose the correct pronoun:

- (He / Him) posted the video yesterday.
- The teacher explained it to (we / us).
- Is this phone (your / yours)?
- (They / Them) attended the rally together.
- Kirk gave (she / her) an interview.

Tip: Subject pronouns come before the verb. Object pronouns come after the verb or preposition. Possessive pronouns replace a noun entirely (e.g., "It is mine.").

Present Simple vs Present Continuous

PRESENT SIMPLE – FORM

Subject + base verb (he/she/it: +s)
Affirmative: She works every day.
Negative: He doesn't travel often.
Question: Do they study English?

PRESENT SIMPLE – USES

Habits and routines
General facts and permanent truths
Schedules and timetables
Repeated actions

PRESENT CONTINUOUS – FORM

Subject + am/is/are + verb–ing
Affirmative: She is working right now.
Negative: He isn't travelling today.
Question: Are they studying at the moment?

PRESENT CONTINUOUS – USES

Actions happening now or around now
Temporary situations
Changing or developing situations
Planned future arrangements

Time Expressions

PRESENT SIMPLE

Always
Usually
Every day
Sometimes
Often

EXAMPLES

"She always checks her email."
"He usually works from home."
"They meet every day."

PRESENT CONTINUOUS

Now
At the moment
Currently
Today
Right now

EXAMPLES

"She is currently working on a report."
"He is studying right now."
"They are meeting today."

Present Simple vs Present Continuous: Comparisons

Present Simple

"He posts videos every day."
"She always reads the news."
"They work in tech."
"Kirk speaks at rallies regularly."
"Social media influences politics."

Present Continuous

"He is posting a video right now."
"She is reading an article today."
"They are working on a project."
"Kirk is speaking at a rally tonight."
"Platforms are changing quickly."

Key Difference

Simple = permanent, habitual, or factual.
Continuous = temporary, in-progress, or happening at this moment. The tense signals duration and frequency to the reader.

Grammar – Practice Exercise

Instructions

Fill in the blank with the correct form: present simple or present continuous. Choose carefully based on context and time expressions.

1. Kirk usually _____ (post) videos every week.

2. Right now, the journalist _____ (write) an article about internet culture.

3. Social media _____ (influence) young people's political views.

4. Look! The students _____ (discuss) the article in pairs.

5. Memes often _____ (spread) very quickly online.

6. At the moment, she _____ (read) a news report about MAGA.

Key Grammar Points

- Pronouns: use subject (I/he/she) as subject, object (me/him/her) after verbs/prepositions
- Possessives: mine/yours/his/hers stand alone — no noun needed after them
- Present Simple: habits, facts, routines → use with always/usually/every day
- Present Continuous: actions happening now or temporarily → use with now/currently
- Common mistake: "He is knowing" ✗ → stative verbs don't use continuous form
- Common mistake: "I am study every day" ✗ → routines require present simple

Wrap Up and Review

Consolidating key learnings from today's session

Review Questions

Content & Culture

What did you learn about Charlie Kirk and internet culture? How does social media influence real-world events?

Grammar

How do personal pronouns and verb tenses (present simple vs. continuous) help improve clarity in technical English writing and speaking?

Vocabulary

Which vocabulary words from the article stood out to you? Share a word, its meaning, and how you might use it in context.

Next Steps

Further Reading & Listening

Read additional news articles about social media and politics.
Watch a short documentary or news segment related to internet culture and activism.

Grammar Practice Reminder

Try to use these tenses when talking, paying attention to the context. Practice more exercises if necessary.

Thank You!

Thank you for your participation!
Questions or comments are welcome.